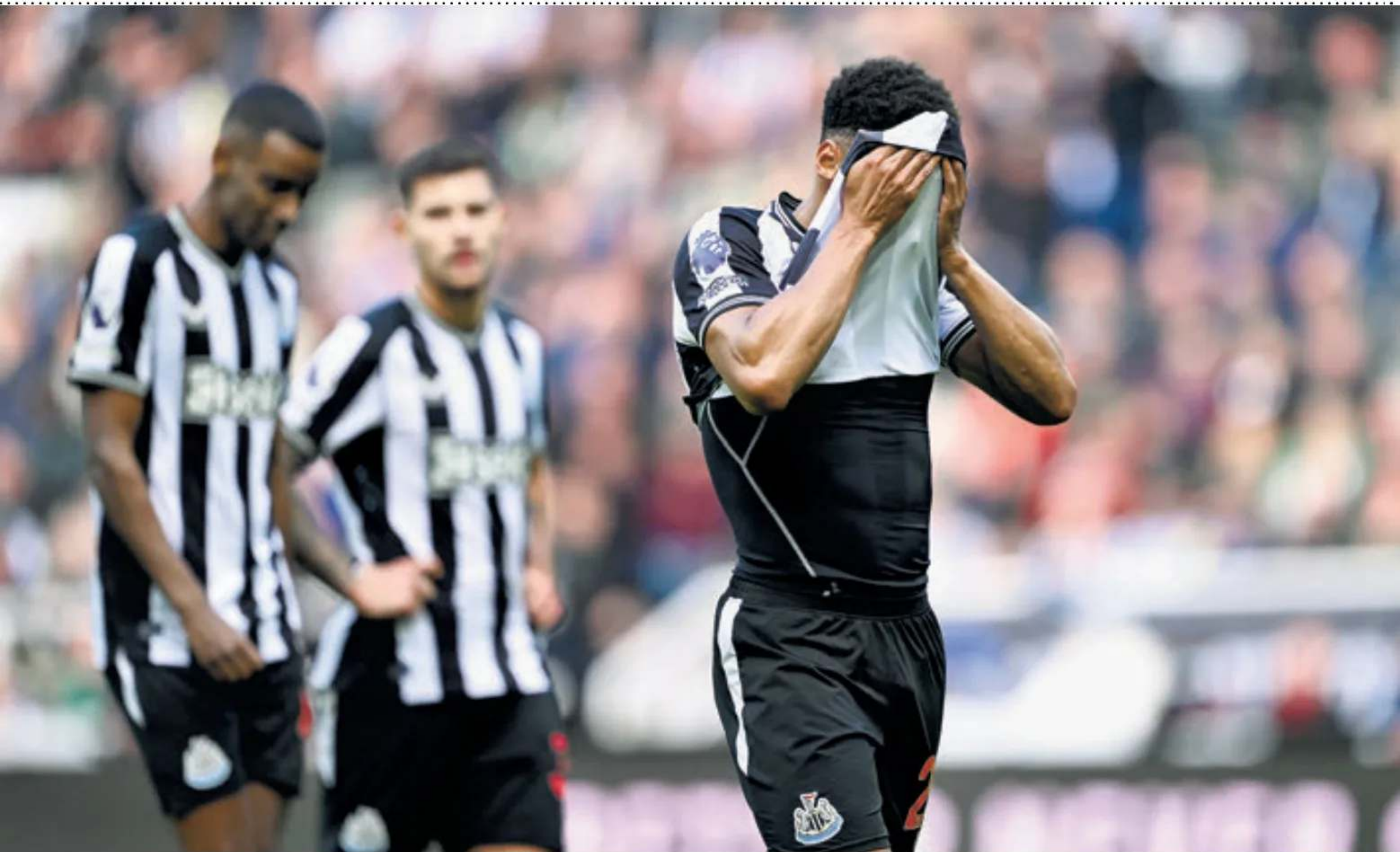




drains magnesium, causing tension, spasms, and sleep issues.

Stress doesn't just challenge performance — it disrupts the very systems that athletes rely on to recover and thrive.

In simpler terms, stress depletes your brain's happy chemicals and energy reserves. Imagine trying to run a marathon without refilling your water bottle — eventually, you'll hit a wall and crash.

That's what happens to athletes if they don't replenish these neurotransmitters and nutrients. Their bodies are pushed to the limit, and without proper recovery, they can't keep up with the demands.

Break the shackles

I've got some secret hacks to restore your neurotransmitters and nutrients, helping you bounce back from stress like never before. It's not just about 'eating healthy'. Athletes need targeted nutrition. Here are some game-changing tips:

- **Tyrosine for dopamine:** Boost dopamine with foods rich in tyrosine

like *paneer*, curd, chicken, fish, *rajma*, *chana*, oats, nuts, bananas, and soy products to keep your brain sharp.

- **Magnesium for relaxation:** A warm cup of almond milk or dark chocolate before bed is perfect for muscle relaxation and better sleep, essential for recovery.

- **Vitamin B smoothies:** A smoothie with spinach, bananas, flax seeds, and protein powder can provide the B vitamins needed to calm your nervous system and combat stress.

- **Omega-3 for brain health:** Fatty fish like salmon or sardines, or Omega-3 supplements, protect neurotransmitters and keep your mind sharp and balanced.

- **Zinc for immune support:** Pumpkin seeds, chickpeas, and cashews are great for boosting zinc levels and strengthening both your brain and immune system during stressful times.

- **Rehydrate with coconut water:** Coconut water replenishes electrolytes like potassium and magnesium without the added

The flip side: When athletes face stress — whether physical or mental — their bodies go into fight-or-flight mode, releasing cortisol and adrenaline to boost energy, speed up heart rate, and sharpen focus. While this helps in the moment, it comes at a cost. GETTY IMAGES

sugars of commercial sports drinks.

These targeted nutrition strategies help athletes recharge both physically and mentally.

Managing stress — both physical and mental — is crucial to an athlete's success. While fitness and mental toughness are key, nutrition plays an equally vital role in preventing burnout.

High-level sports bring inevitable stress, but how athletes handle it can be the difference between winning and exhaustion.

The secret? Train smarter, not just harder.

Prioritise nutrition, replenish what's lost, and fuel your body with the right nutrients to handle stress like a true champion.